

The Ohio State University Consent to Participate in Research

Study Title: Mindfulness in Motion Targeted to Sustaining the Mental and Physical Resilience of First Responders and Health System Employees

Protocol Number: 2022B0254

Researcher: Dr. Maryanna Klatt, PhD

Sponsor: Ohio Bureau of Workers Compensation

This is a consent form for research participation. It contains important information about this study and what to expect if you decide to participate.

Your participation is voluntary.

Please consider the information carefully. Feel free to ask questions before making your decision whether or not to participate.

Purpose:

The purpose of this study is to utilize the success of an existing resilience building program, Mindfulness in Motion (MIM), and reformat the content and material for the specific needs of the First Responder (FR) community. Interventions within the MIM program align with a growing body of research demonstrating that mindfulness and physical activity can bolster stress resilience by preventing an increase in inflammatory biomarkers. MIM is currently delivered in a group format (originally in-person, now virtually via web-based videos), and includes didactic instruction, community-building group discussion, mindfulness, and gentle yoga. As the first responder work environment represents an untested and unique context for MIM delivery, we plan to adapt the MIM program to target the specific needs of FRs. To complete this aim, we will conduct interviews with about 10 firefighter/paramedics and about 10 police force members from various agencies across the state of Ohio. These interviews will inform the new content for MIM specific to First Responders and also the production of video-based yoga and stretches made for the needs to first responders.

Procedures/Tasks:

Interviews:

During the interview portion of the study, data will be collected over separate, open-ended interviews. Each interview is expected to last 30-60 minutes and will span four areas:

- 1) Experiences of occupational stress
- 2) Current strategies of occupational stress reduction
- 3) Experiences and barriers with practicing mindfulness

4) Thoughts and opinions on implementation of a mindfulness program and an app designed specifically for First Responders

Interviews will be conducted by one member of the research team who will use Microsoft Teams as the video chat application. If public health concerns lift regarding COVID-19, we may conduct these interviews in person by the research team member. You will not be required to download any software. You will be able to access the video chat portal using a web link that the team provides to you. If you do not have access to a web browser or prefer to speak by telephone, the team member will conduct that interview using the calling function in Microsoft Teams. All interviews that are conducted using Microsoft Teams will be digitally audio-recorded. If you do not have access to an internet connection, the interview will be conducted via phone with the team member recording the interview.

We may wish to quote you, without revealing your identity, from your interview in our publications and presentations. We will first ask for your consent today to quote you from your interview. If you agree to us quoting you, we will not identify you by name. You can also tell us that you do not wish to be quoted. You can tell us now that you do not wish to be quoted, or you can tell us during the interview at any time.

Duration:

You will be asked to complete a semi-structured interview taking 30-60 minutes to complete. Total time commitment from consenting and interview should range from 45-75 minutes for this phase of the study.

You may leave the study at any time. If you decide to stop participating in the study, there will be no penalty to you, and you will not lose any benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. Your decision will not affect your future relationship with The Ohio State University.

Risks and Benefits:

The anticipated potential risks are loss of privacy, negative feelings that may arise during or after completing the measures and/or interviews (e.g. embarrassment, frustration, anger), fatigue as a result of being interviewed. We allow participants to elect to turn their cameras off, in the case one would feel uncomfortable having their video image recorded. Therefore, we give everyone the option to turn their camera off and just have an audio recording generated from the interview. In any or either case, neither video nor audio files would be shared beyond members of the research team. Loss of privacy can occur if data files are breached during data collection, transmission or storage, or if someone is able to attribute a quote or details in a publication to an individual participant.

It is not guaranteed that you will benefit directly from participating in this research study. However, agreeing to be interviewed may benefit you by contributing to your own well-being, or by helping others by influencing how the Mindfulness in Motion for First Responders

program and supporting mobile app is designed to best meet the needs of first responders. It is hoped that the results of this study will be useful to understand the stress and barriers First Responders face while working to improve their well-being.

Confidentiality:

We will work to make sure that no one sees your online responses without approval. But, because we are using the Internet, there is a chance that someone could access your online responses without permission. In some cases, this information could be used to identify you.

Also, there may be circumstances where this information must be released. For example, personal information regarding your participation in this study may be disclosed if required by state law. Also, your records may be reviewed by the following groups (as applicable to the research):

- Office for Human Research Protections or other federal, state, or international regulatory agencies;
- The Ohio State University Institutional Review Board or Office of Responsible Research Practices;
- Authorized Ohio State University staff not involved in the study may be aware that you are participating in a research study and have access to your information; and
- The sponsor, if any, or agency (including the Food and Drug Administration for FDA-regulated research) supporting the study.

Because the study is a qualitative exploratory design intended to elicit the meaning of occupational stress in your role as a first responder it is not intended to identify findings about individual participants that are relevant to them. The research team will share aggregated, de-identified findings from the interviews with participants as part of our commitment to respect for persons.

Future Research

Your de-identified information may be used or shared with other researchers without your additional informed consent. Additionally, we may have other mindfulness and well-being studies that you may be interested in. Please indicate below if you are interested in being contacted for future studies.

☐ **Yes, I give my permission** to be contacted again for Aim 4 of the study

☐ No, I do not give my permission to be contacted again for Aim 4 of the study

Incentives:

By law, payments to participants are considered taxable income. You will receive \$50 in the form an Amazon gift card your participation in this study.

Participant Rights:

You may refuse to participate in this study without penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. If you are a student or employee at Ohio State, your decision will not affect your grades or employment status.

If you choose to participate in the study, you may discontinue participation at any time without penalty or loss of benefits. By agreeing to participate, you do not give up any personal legal rights you may have as a participant in this study.

An Institutional Review Board responsible for human subjects research at The Ohio State University reviewed this research project and found it to be acceptable, according to applicable state and federal regulations and University policies designed to protect the rights and welfare of participants in research.

Contacts and Questions:

For questions, concerns, or complaints about the study, or you feel you have been harmed as a result of study participation, you may contact **Dr. Maryanna Klatt at 614-293-3644 or Maryanna.Klatt@osumc.edu**

For questions about your rights as a participant in this study or to discuss other study-related concerns or complaints with someone who is not part of the research team, you may contact the Office of Responsible Research Practices at 1-800-678-6251 or hsconcerns@osu.edu.

Providing consent

I have read (or someone has read to me) this page and I am aware that I am being asked to participate in a research study. I have had the opportunity to ask questions and have had them answered to my satisfaction. I voluntarily agree to participate in this study. I am not giving up any legal rights by agreeing to participate.

To print or save a copy of this page, select the print button on your web browser.

☐ Yes, I agree to participate in this study
☐ No, I decline to participate in this study

Please click the button below to proceed and participate in this study. If you do not wish to participate, please close out your browser window.